the street from what would become Loftus Versfeld, one of the world's most famous rugby grounds, home of the Bulls and the site of many Springbok triumphs.

For me, Affies is everything.

I am massively proud to be an Affies old boy and hugely privileged to be associated with the school; and I will always be grateful for the values instilled in me during my formative years, between 1998 and 2002.

From that scary day at the start of our first year when the matric boy asked us to write out the Honour Code 100 times to being introduced to my 'mentor', an older boy named Anton Swanepoel (I called him 'Meester Swannies' and he used to call me BA), through all the traditions to instil discipline, humility and respect, I loved the spirit.

Believe me, it's a special place.

This simple fact first dawned on me one bright, bracing Highveld winter's day in 1992. Under clear blue skies, in perfect sunshine, 12 000 people had gathered at the school to watch Affies play an Administrator's Cup rugby match on the A field. My brother Wessels had started at Affies at the beginning of that year and my parents reckoned this was an ideal opportunity for us all to drive from Warmbaths to Pretoria to see him.

As an eight-year-old younger brother, I looked around in awe. The sheer number of assembled parents, families, friends and old boys was impressive, but I couldn't take my eyes off the packed bank of white-shirted Affies boys filling the stand on the eastern side of the ground, packed shoulder to shoulder, singing their school songs from start to finish.

It was a great day.

'I want to go to Affies,' I told my mother as we drove home.

She smiled.

'I'm serious,' I said.

I was fascinated by anything and everything associated with Affies, and I started to take a particular interest in my older brother's school